

2023 - Spring

Introduction to Leadership & Management for Engineers

Final Homework

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Q1: Which leadership style do you see in Steve Job's leadership approach & what makes you think so, based on the related article?

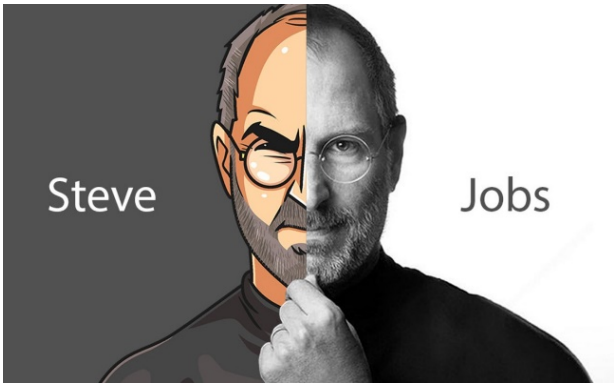


Steve Jobs was an exceptional leader whose style of leadership included a number of traits that made him stand out. His visionary outlook was one of the most noticeable aspects of his leadership style. Jobs demonstrated a remarkable aptitude for predicting trends and developing ground-breaking products throughout his career. He envisioned the personal computer as a "digital hub" for organizing music, films, and content, as stated in the article, which led to the development of the iPod and iPad. He revolutionized the personal-device business and influenced the course of technology thanks to his imaginative leadership style.

He paid meticulous attention to every last detail, which is another admirable quality of Jobs' leadership style. Jobs exhibited the uncommon talent to flourish in both fields, unlike many CEOs who only concentrate on the large picture or micromanage every area. The article highlights his capacity to create broad strategies while methodically fussing over even the most minute design details. He was known to worry about details like the color and shape of the screws in his iMac, for example. This exacting attention to detail demonstrated his dedication to excellence and his active participation in all facets of product creation.

Jobs' innovative fusion of the humanities and sciences was one of the most intriguing aspects of his leadership style. Even though he first considered himself a humanities guy, he saw the importance of combining these two fields of study. Jobs refers to Edwin Land's viewpoint on the confluence of the humanities and sciences as a crucial source of inspiration in the essay. Jobs skillfully combined creativity with technology, art with engineering, and the result was the creation of cutting-edge products with appealing aesthetics. The author's conviction that developing a creative edge in the twenty-first century requires a solid foundation in both the humanities and sciences is highlighted in the article.

A relentless pursuit of excellence was another aspect of Jobs' leadership style. He had a reputation for establishing high goals for himself and his team and then pushing them to be met. Apple's success in developing products that were not only technologically cutting edge but also aesthetically pleasing and user-friendly was largely due to Jobs' obsession on perfection. One of the most important aspects of his leadership style was his capacity to uplift and encourage his people to pursue excellence.



Last but not least, Jobs' leadership style was characterized by his readiness to question the established quo and adopt a nonconformist outlook. He brought a defiant and disruptive energy to his art and was the quintessential counterculture figure of the 1960s. The article cites Apple's "1984" advertisement and the "Think Different" campaign as instances of Jobs demonstrating his rebellious and countercultural tendencies, highlighting his conviction that outcasts and troublemakers have the ability to alter the world.

As a result, Steve Jobs' management style was a singular synthesis of imaginative thinking, exacting attention to detail, fusing the humanities and sciences, striving for excellence, and a rebellious attitude. He stands out as a transformative leader because of his capacity to see the future, pay attention to minute details, bridge disciplines, and motivate his team. These observations are supported by the information provided in the essay, which also sheds important light on one of the most important personalities in the technology sector's leadership style.

Q2: How do you describe Job's leadership mistakes?

- **in terms of EQ**

Despite being well-known for his ground-breaking inventions and commercial triumphs, Steve Jobs also made numerous leadership errors that may be studied through the prism of emotional intelligence (EQ).

Empathy is one obvious area where Jobs' leadership style may have caused difficulties from an EQ perspective. Jobs, who was renowned for his strict and direct style, had high standards for his team members and had a tendency to be straight with his criticism. This directness, nevertheless, might have occasionally lacked compassion for the thoughts and feelings of others. Jobs' approach may have fell short in this area because it is crucial to recognize and understand the emotions of team members. Collaboration is another area where Jobs' leadership style might have used some EQ enhancement. Jobs' success was largely due to his clear vision and steadfast faith in his theories. However, his propensity to reject opposing points of view and his propensity to impose his will could stymie productive collaboration. Openness, active listening, and taking into account different viewpoints are all aspects of emotional intelligence that are crucial for building collaborative situations.



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Last but not least, Jobs' unwavering commitment to excellence and focus on developing ground-breaking innovations occasionally came above fostering long-term connections. Building and maintaining healthy connections as well as being aware of how one's actions affect others are all parts of having emotional intelligence. Jobs' leadership style occasionally appeared to favor achievement over interpersonal relationships, which may be interpreted as an EQ deficiency.

It is crucial to take these factors into account in light of the particular difficulties and conditions that Jobs faced during his career. Although his management style has undeniably beneficial effects and contributed significantly to Apple's success, these pointed out areas for development show potential leadership errors in terms of emotional intelligence.

- **in terms of 7 bad habits**



1. Winning too much: In every circumstance, Steve Jobs was known for his tenacious pursuit of perfection and passion for Apple's success. While his desire for triumph helped him succeed, it may also be interpreted as a need to rule and win at all costs, which might cast a shadow over cooperation and teamwork.

2. Adding too much value: Jobs was renowned for having strong beliefs and a propensity to vehemently defend them. This conduct might have prevented candid conversations and prevented other people from contributing. The team may not have been able to consider different points of view due to the member's overpowering urge to always give his views.

3. Not listening: Jobs was a leader with a clear vision for the goods and strategy of Apple. He occasionally came out as contemptuous of other viewpoints, though. It may be difficult to innovate and make good decisions if you don't actively listen to and take into account the opinions of others.

4. Making destructive comments: Jobs was known for his direct, often abrasive, manner of communication. Although he may have meant to encourage brilliance, unnecessary sarcasm and insults can have a negative effect on the workplace culture and demoralize employees. Such remarks may impede cooperation and undermine trust within the company.

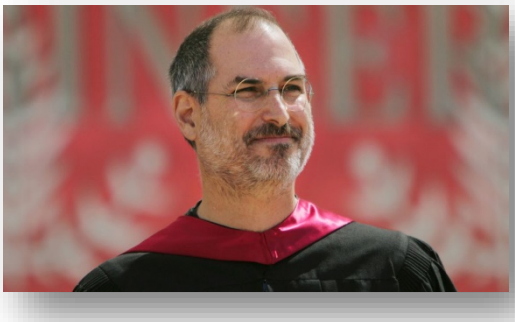
5. Speaking when angry: Jobs' fervor and drive occasionally caused emotional outbursts, such as expressing fury in public. While he might have thought that doing this demonstrated his dedication and high standards, employing emotional turbulence as a management strategy can instill dread and damage positive team dynamics.



6. Failing to give proper recognition: Jobs was intensely motivated to produce the finest results, yet there were times when he neglected to properly acknowledge the accomplishments of his team members. Employee engagement and morale may have been affected by the inability to praise and reward employees.

7. Failing to express gratitude: Jobs was motivated by a desire for greatness, yet he occasionally failed to express his gratitude. Simple expressions of gratitude can go a long way toward cultivating strong connections and developing a respect and appreciation-based culture.

Q3: Which leadership style do you recommend Job to follow & why (as much as concrete & specific)?



When thinking about the late Steve Jobs' leadership style, a combination of transformative and inclusive leadership is one strategy that may have further increased his effectiveness. Even though Jobs was renowned for his innovative and imaginative leadership style, adopting these traits could have led to even more success.

Given that transformational leadership places a strong emphasis on inspiring and motivating people, it would have been a good suggestion for Jobs. Jobs had a natural capacity to enliven enthusiasm and passion in his employees, which could have been enhanced by purposefully encouraging creativity and invention. Jobs would have given his team members the tools to realize their full potential, which would have resulted in even bigger accomplishments, by fostering a culture that supports personal development.

Additionally, Jobs might have benefited from using a more inclusive leadership approach. Although he had firm beliefs and a distinct vision, actively seeking and appreciating different points of view would have given him access to a wider variety of thoughts and insights. Collaboration and the use of collective intelligence are fostered by inclusive leadership. Jobs might have built an even more solid platform for innovation and success by valuing the opinions of all team members. The boldness and decisiveness of Jobs would not have been compromised by incorporating these leadership philosophies. Instead, they would have enhanced his already strong points and given his leadership style a teamwork, empathetic, and wider perspective component. Jobs could have fostered a culture where people felt encouraged to share their own talents and ideas while also being inspired by his vision by fusing inclusive and transformative leadership. His team members would have developed an even greater sense of dedication, loyalty, and ownership as a result of this combination.

In conclusion, advising Steve Jobs to adopt a leadership style that includes transformative and inclusive components would have increased the effect of his work. These approaches would have maximized his team's potential, encouraged more creativity, and promoted a collaborative atmosphere. In the end, this strategy would have aided Jobs in carrying on his record of transforming industries and developing ground-breaking innovations.

